



Princess Baylin and the Lost Rain Song

A Princess Baylin Diaries bedtime story



*Princess Baylin and the Lost Rain Song
Episode 1 of the Princess Baylin Diaries*

Created from Kevin's stories, brought to life with AI.

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For every little listener.



Far away, in the Kingdom of Sunhill, where the hills roll soft and gold, there lives a little princess called Baylin.

She wears a crown of grass and flowers. She has happy bare feet. And she has a very good friend named Tilly. Tilly is a tortoise. She does everything slowly, and that is part of her magic.



One soft morning, Baylin and Tilly stepped into the palace garden.

"Oh," whispered Baylin. "Look at the flowers."

The flowers hung their little heads. Their leaves were dry and thirsty. The pond, which usually sparkled like a mirror, was almost empty. A small frog sat on a lily pad that looked far too big for the water left underneath.



Tilly blinked one slow blink. "It has not rained for a long, long time," she said. "Even the grass is whispering for a drink."

Baylin knelt down and touched a petal with one careful finger. It felt like paper.

"Don't worry, little flower," she said, trying to sound brave. "We will find a way to help."



They followed the dusty path to the old fig tree at the edge of the garden.

High on a branch sat the Rainbird. Her feathers were soft and grey-blue, and her eyes looked tired.

"Hello, Rainbird," said Baylin gently. "Why do you look so sad?"

The Rainbird sighed a small, sad sigh.



"I have forgotten my rain song," said the Rainbird. "Without my song, the clouds do not know when to gather. Without the rain, the garden grows thirsty."

Baylin's heart gave a little squeeze. She loved her garden, and she wanted to fix it, fast.

"I can help!" she said. "I will sing it for you!"



*Baylin ran up the hill as fast as her feet could carry her. Up,
up, up, to the very top.*

*She stood tall. She filled her lungs. And she sang as loudly as
she could.*

"Come, rain! Come, rain! Come, RAIN!"

*She sang higher. She sang louder. She even stamped her foot
for extra power.*



And then... puff!

A tiny cloud of dust rose up from the dry ground. That was all. No grey clouds. No rain. Only dust, which made Baylin cough a tiny cough.

She sat down on the warm grass. "Why didn't it work?" she asked. Her cheeks felt hot and cross.

But the day was still gentle, and Tilly was on her way.



*Step... by step... by step, Tilly reached the top of the hill at last.
"You sang very bravely," said Tilly. "But maybe we need to listen,
not shout."*

Baylin frowned. "Listen to what?"

*"To the garden," said Tilly. "To our friends. Sometimes a song is
not kept in one place. Sometimes it is shared out, in little pieces."*



Baylin took a slow breath. She closed her eyes. She sat very, very still.

Listen... what do you hear?

(Shh. Close your eyes and listen too.)

Maybe you hear the wind. Maybe you hear a bird. In Sunhill, Baylin began to hear something too: the soft wish of a thirsty garden, waiting to be heard.



First they went to the pond. The frogs sat on their lily pads like little green musicians.

"Please," said Baylin, very softly now, "do you remember any part of the rain song?"

The biggest frog smiled a wide frog smile. "We remember the drum," he said. "The deep, slow beat of raindrops on the water. Boom. Boom. Boom."



"Thank you," said Baylin. "That is a wonderful piece."

She did not rush away. She sat by the pond, and she waited, and she listened. Boom. Boom. Boom. She listened until the frog drum lived inside her ears, as steady as a heartbeat.

Can you drum it with your hands? Boom. Boom. Boom.



*Next they walked through the long grass, where grasshoppers
leapt like tiny sparks of gold.*

*"Hello, grasshoppers," whispered Baylin. "Do you remember any
part of the rain song?"*

*"We remember the patter!" chirped one. "The quick, light taps
when rain kisses the leaves. Tip. Tip. Tip-tip."*



*Baylin smiled a big smile. "The drum and the patter," she said.
"Two pieces already!"*

*She tapped her fingers on her knees. Tip. Tip. Tip-tip.
Tilly's eyes shone slowly, the way tortoise eyes do when hope
is growing.*

Can you patter with your fingers? Tip. Tip. Tip-tip.



At last they came back to the old fig tree. Baylin laid her hand on the warm bark.

"Grandmother Tree," she said, "do you remember any part of the rain song?"

The tree swayed kindly. Her leaves whispered like pages turning.

"I remember the hum of the wind," she said, in a voice like quiet wood. "The long, soft note before the rain arrives. Hmmm..."



*Baylin closed her eyes again and hummed along. Hmmm...
Drum. Patter. Hum. Three pieces of the song, held carefully in
her heart, like three smooth pebbles in a pocket.*

"Thank you, Grandmother Tree," she said.

Can you hum like the wind? Hmmm...



They brought all the pieces to the Rainbird. Baylin tried to put them in order.

Drum, then patter, then hum. Hum, then drum, then patter. Nothing quite fitted. The Rainbird shook her head gently. "I still can't hear the tune," she said.

Baylin's shoulders dropped. "Maybe I am not enough," she whispered.



Tilly bumped Baylin's ankle with her shell, soft as a hug.

"Tortoises get there in the end," said Tilly. "We do not win by being first. We win by staying kind, and by staying with our friends."

Baylin looked at the frogs, the grasshoppers, the Grandmother Tree and the Rainbird.

"Then we will try together," she said.



"Ready?" asked Baylin.

The frogs began the drum. Boom. Boom. Boom.

The grasshoppers added the patter. Tip. Tip. Tip-tip.

The Grandmother Tree gave the hum of the wind. Hmmm...

Nobody was loudest. Nobody was first. Everybody listened to everybody else. And Baylin did not shout. She hummed softly, so every friend could be heard.



And then, like a door opening in the sky, the Rainbird remembered.

Her voice found the missing tune. It was not loud. It was not showy. It was true. It wove the drum and the patter and the hum into one gentle rain song.

Boom, tip-tip, hmmm. Boom, tip-tip, hmmm.

The song had come home.



Above them, the clouds gathered like soft grey blankets. Then came the rain.

Soft drops. Kind drops. Drops that made tiny circles on the pond and tiny crowns on the dusty path.

The flowers lifted their heads. The grass drank and drank. Baylin held out her hands and laughed as the cool rain danced on her palms.



"The song was never lost," said Baylin, smiling. "It was shared out. Each of you carried a small piece."

She thanked the frogs for the drum. She thanked the grasshoppers for the patter. She thanked the Grandmother Tree for the hum. She thanked Tilly for teaching her to listen. And she thanked the Rainbird for singing the tune home.



As the light grew soft and sleepy, the rain became a gentle whisper. Baylin knelt by the pond with Tilly and folded her hands.

"Thank you, friends!" she said.

Then she tipped her face to the sky and whispered goodnight, the way she always does when a story is done. "Thank you, rain. Thank you, Sunhill. Goodnight."



*From high in the old fig tree came a soft, round sound.
"Hoo-hoo." It was Bonayo, the wise old owl, waking up for the
night.*

*"Well listened, Princess Baylin," said Bonayo. "Goodnight,
Sunhill."*

*Now it is your turn, little listener. What small thing can you
do to help your friends today? Perhaps you can listen.
Listening is a kind of love.*



The End

Goodnight, little listener. Sleep well. The rain will keep singing softly while you dream. Boom, tip-tip, hmmm.

Next time: Princess Baylin and the Sleepy Moon.

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